FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-31-19006

Issue Title : Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit (DFDAU) BlockPoint 1 Data Dropout

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3131-22	-8
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/16/2019	10/30/2026	11/07/2020
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Updated the Service Bulletin applicability.

***NOTE* This is an older FTD is being updated to correct the Line Number applicability. Be aware there is a newer ACMS OPS (P/N: TDY4E-7095-1805) released in 2023 which is documented in 737MAX-FTD-31-23001, 737-SL-31-086, and 737-31-2130**

Applicability

All 737MAX Airplanes prior to Line position 7346, including 7348, 7433, 7435, 7446, except for 5728, 6250, 6744, 6798, 7260, 7263, 7273, 7285, and above with Teledyne Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit (DFDAU) Part Number (P/N) 2245000-101 with Blockpoint 1 (BP1) software and Compact Fast (CFast) card, or 737 MAX airplanes that have incorporated DFDAU BP1 software (Service Bulletin SB 737-31-1801).

Description

737 MAX Airplanes with Teledyne DFDAU Part Number (P/N) 2245000-101 with DFDAU BP1 Software DFDAU Airplane Condition Monitoring System (ACMS) Operational Program Software (OPS) Target System Software (TSS) P/N TDY48-7095-1803 and CFast card installed have been discovered to be experiencing data dropouts. Dropouts have been observed in Air Data Reference: Quick Access Recorder (ADR:QAR) or QAR data obtained from the Onboard Network System (ONS) Download Manager, and in the CFast card Digital ACMS Recorder (DAR) data.

A systems logging function which writes to the CFast card was added to DFDAU BP1 software. This function supports potential fault diagnostics in case of DFDAU failure. More information on the DFDAU BP1 software upgrade can be found in Service Letter (SL) 737-SL-31-070.

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The fault assessment indicates that the CFast logging function and the DAR recording function are competing for DFDAU processing resources, leading to the data dropout. Installation of CFast card have been found to contribute to increase the data drop rate in ADR:QAR data, and data gaps of 17 seconds have also been observed in some of the CFast card DAR data. Note: The data drops will only be observed in processed data.

Please also note there is another ADR:QAR data dropout condition related to the Network File Server (NFS) that is unrelated to the condition described here. More information can be found in Fleet Team Digest (FTD) 737MAX-FTD-46-19001.

Status

Teledyne and Boeing have completed testing software containing the fix to DFDAU ACMS OPS TSS P/N TDY48-7095-1803. The retrofit Boeing Service Bulletin SB 737-31-1956 was released on May 01,2020.

Interim Action

If data drops are observed, recommended interim action is dependent on whether the ONS-QAR-DAR option 3135E526B33 is selected. The ONS-QAR-DAR recording option provides the ability to obtain ADR:QAR data from the ONS Download Manager per AMM TASK 46-13-02-970-802.

If an operator has the ONS-QAR-DAR recording option selected, Boeing recommends installing DFDAU BP1 without the CFast card installed in the DFDAU. BP1 software provides the solution for the DFDR "OFF" cockpit light annunciation issue and more information can be found in 737-SL-31-070. The DAR data can be obtained from the ONS Download Manager per AMM TASK 46-13-02-970-802.

If an operator does not have the ONS-QAR-DAR recording option selected, operators have the following options:

1. Install DFDAU BP1 software with the CFast card installed in the DFDAU. DFDAU BP1 software provides the solution for the DFDR "OFF" cockpit light annunciation issue and more information on the DFDR "OFF" light can be found in 737-SL-31-070. However, there may be data dropout observed in the CFast card DAR data.

2. Install DFDAU BP1 software without the CFast card installed in the DFDAU. DFDAU BP1 software provides the solution for the DFDR "OFF" cockpit light annunciation issue and more information on the DFDR "OFF" light can be found in 737-SL-31-070.

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However, DAR data will not be available.

3. Install DFDAU BP0 software with the CFast card installed in the DFDAU. The data dropout issue related to DFDAU BP1 software will not be observed in the CFast card DAR data. However, the DFDR "OFF" cockpit light annunciation issue may be present and may interrupt fleet operation. More information on the DFDR "OFF" light can be found in 737-SL-31-070.

More information on the DFDAU BP0 and DFDAU BP1 software and how to obtain and install the software parts can be found in 737-SL-31-070 and Service Bulletin SB-737-31-1801. CFast card recommendations can be found in Teledyne Service Letter SL2245000 No. 1 CFast Media Recommendations and Best Practices and instructions to install CFast card can be found in AMM TASK 31-31-22-470-804.

Final Action

To provide a fix to this dropout issue, Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit (DFDAU) BP1.1 Target System Software (TSS) will be incorporated in production starting on Line Number 7909 and the retrofit Boeing Service Bulletin SB 737-31-1956 was released on May 01,2020. Service Letter 737-31-079 was also published on July 17 2020.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: 15-MAR-19 (complete)

Solution Selected: 15-OCT-19 (complete)

Change Committed: 15-NOV-19 (complete)

Production Incorporation, All 737MAX Airplanes after Line position 7346, including 7348, 7433, 7435, 7446. November-2020(complete)

Service Bulletin Available: SB 737-31-1956 01-May-2020 (complete)

Parts Available: July-2020 (complete)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date

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Production Revision Record (PRR)	3M9900-051R		
Service Letter (SL)	Teledyne Service Letter SL2245000	No. 1	07/31/2018
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	TASK 31-31-22-470-804		
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-31-070	A	04/25/2019
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-31-1801		11/29/2018
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	TASK 46-13-02-970-802		
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737MAX-FTD-46-19001		
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-31-079		07/17/2020

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit (DFDAU)	2245000-101	Teledyne	
ACMS OPS Target System Software	TDY49-7095-1803	Teledyne	

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability

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